

Major suit raises

This set of practice deals is about very basic bidding using only Major suit bids. The Major suits are Hearts and Spades.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam. The important point is figuring out how many combined points the partnership has.

Keep in mind:

you need 26 points to make game (4♥ 4♠)

you need 33 points to make slam (6♥ 6♠)

open 1♥ or 1♠ with 13-21 points at least five of the suit

respond by raising to 2-level with 6-10 points and at least three of the suit

respond by raising to 3-level with 11-12 points and at least three of the suit

respond by raising to 4-level with 13-16 points and at least three of the suit

respond by raising to 4-level with 8-12 points and at least five of the suit

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3♥

Declarer: North

Lead: ♠3

Board: 2

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 1♠

Declarer: East

Lead: ♦J

Board: 3

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: South

Lead: ♣K

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 3♥

Declarer: West

Lead: ♦8

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A Q J 8

♥ J 10

♦ K Q 3

♣ J 7 3 2

♠ 10 9 2

♥ A K 5 4 2

♦ 8 5

♣ A K Q



♠ K 5 3

♥ 9 8

♦ 10 9 7 6 2

♣ 10 6 4

♠ 7 6 4

♥ Q 7 6 3

♦ A J 4

♣ 9 8 5

*West**North**East**South*

1♥

Pass

2♥

Pass

3♥

All Pass

3♥ by North

Lead: ♠3

NORTH opens 1♥ with 17 points and five ♥s.

SOUTH, with 7 points and four trumps raises to 2♥.

NORTH has a mid-range hand, good enough to invite SOUTH to bid the game.

Too bad, but SOUTH is too weak to accept any invitations.

Board 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 6 3
♥ 9 8 5 3
♦ 8 6 4 3
♣ 9 2

♠ Q 9 2

♥ 10 6

♦ K Q 2

♣ K 10 8 7 5



♠ K J 8 7 4

♥ K 7 2

♦ A 9 5

♣ A Q

♠ 10 5

♥ A Q J 4

♦ J 10 7

♣ J 6 4 3

WEST has a terrible hand, and naturally passes.

EAST, however, has a nice 18 points and opens 1♠.

WEST still has a terrible hand, and passes again. You need at least 6 points to respond to an opening one bid.

West

Pass

All Pass

1♠ by East

Lead: ♦ J

North

Pass

East

1♠

South

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 7 2
 ♥ 8 6 5 3 2
 ♦ J 8 7
 ♣ K Q 9

♠ 10 9 6 3

♥ K Q 4

♦ 9 6 4 2

♣ A 7



♠ A 8

♥ J 10 9

♦ A 10 3

♣ 10 5 4 3 2

♠ K Q J 5 4

♥ A 7

♦ K Q 5

♣ J 8 6

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1 ♠
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	3 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			
Lead: ♣K			

SOUTH has 17 points and might open 1NT. But with the 5-card Major suit she prefers to open 1 ♠.

NORTH has good ♠ support and 10 points, counting 1 for the doubleton ♣. It is easily worth a raise to 2 ♠.

SOUTH cannot bid game yet, after all, NORTH could have as few as 6 points. But she can continue with a 3 ♠ bid in hopes that NORTH actually has 9 or 10 points.

NORTH comes through with 4 ♠.

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ K J 6
♥ K J 8 5 2
♦ A 7 4
♣ 8 5

♠ Q 10 9

♥ 10 3

♦ Q 9 8 5

♣ K 9 7 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 8 7 2

♥ Q 9 6 4

♦ K 6 2

♣ A Q 3

♠ A 5 4 3

♥ A 7

♦ J 10 3

♣ J 10 6 4

West

1♥

All Pass

3♥ by West

Lead: ♦8

North

Pass

East

3♥

South

WEST has a bare minimum 13 point hand, and he should open 1♥.

EAST has 11 points and good ♥ support so she jumps to 3♥.

WEST knows he has been invited to bid higher, but with nothing above minimum he must pass.